

"I really believe my former partners want to be the richest men in the world," Big Bill told me. "They're so rich now they haven't the slightest idea how much they're worth. Still, they work harder than ever. They're going into new areas, things they know nothing about. They're a bundle of nerves. Two are getting divorces, two have had heart attacks. I think they all have ulcers. They rarely have a talk with their grown kids that doesn't end in a shouting match. All they get for it is more money. And they've already got all the money they need."

Big Bill's partners present one extreme and Big Bill the other. You may find a happy medium. But most of us keep working until we're 55 or 60 regardless of whether we need the money, enjoy the job, or would like to do other things.

DON'T TOUGH IT OUT

Big Bill does exactly what he wants with his life. You don't have Big Bill's millions, but you may have enough to retire. The only difference between you and Big Bill is that while you may have just enough to retire, he has more than enough. Big Bill replaced work with a yacht. You can't afford a yacht. But perhaps you can afford \$50 a day. In chapter 8 I show how two people can put together a retired life that costs \$50 a day. In chapter 9 I show how two people with children can put together a retired life that costs only slightly more than \$50 a day. And in chapter 11 I discuss bare-bones retirement—how to live well on even less than \$50 a day.

But you have to decide to get out of the rat race now. Toughing it out where you are can lead to trouble. You may end up like Big Bill's partners on a smaller scale. Gail Sheehy writes in *Passages*:

Most middle managers know they are a dime a dozen. A man in this familiar state, feeling unappreciated and